Emma Chiu

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Education

Northwestern University, Evanston, IL — Aug 2020 — Jun 2024

B.A. in Economics (with Honors), B.A. in Mathematics, Minor in Data Science

- **GPA**: 3.95/4.0, **GRE**: 339/340
- **Thesis**: The Impacts of Teacher Turnover: A Comparative Study of Public and Charter Schools in Illinois *(advised by Prof. Jonathan Guryan)*
- **Relevant Coursework**: Linear Algebra, Differential Equations, Real Analysis, Graph Theory, Probability & Stochastic Processes, Abstract Algebra, Econometrics, Data Science with Machine Learning

Work Experience

Walmart, *Economist*, New York City, NY — Jun 2023 — Aug 2023, Aug 2024 — Present

- Ran 5+ nationwide field experiments examining labor supply responses to earnings and behavioral nudges in the gig market, spanning design, power testing, randomization, analysis, and presentation to leadership
- Trained and evaluated an instrumental forest using experimental data to estimate heterogeneous treatment effects of incentive pay, outperforming random targeting in identifying the most cost-effective gig drivers
- Examined the effects of geographically and temporally staggered store wage hikes using high-volume labor data and an event-study design; explored geographic spillovers and sensitivity to choice of radius
- Estimated delivery speed elasticity with a stacked regression discontinuity design, formally testing assumptions and conducting robustness checks
- Managed and mentored a summer intern conducting a causal evaluation of a nonrandomly deployed labor-allocation change using matching, synthetic controls, and synthetic difference-in-differences

Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco, *Analytics Intern*, San Francisco, CA — Jun 2022 — Aug 2022

- Analyzed employee talent and onsite metrics, pinpointing performance gaps and areas for improvement
- Developed and maintained 4 dashboards tracking Bank progress toward strategic goals
- Collected and visualized intern and manager survey data to evaluate program outcomes and experiences

Chicago Public Schools, *Policy Data Intern*, Chicago, IL — Jan 2022 — Mar 2022

- Reviewed academic literature on school quality measurement and accountability policies
- Synthesized parent and teacher surveys, staff interviews, and district performance data to identify determinants of school choice and inform a redesign of the School Quality Rating Policy
- Created slide decks and briefings translating complex school performance metrics into relevant, accessible information for families and district stakeholders

Research Experience

Prof. Stephane Mechoulan, *Dalhousie University*, Evanston, IL — Oct 2022 — Present

- Implemented a prediction-based outcome test on longitudinal law firm data to measure discrimination in promotion decisions, adapting statistical tests from relevant literature to support methodological validity
- Produced publication-ready tables and figures containing descriptive statistics, results of assumption testing, and outcome test estimates across various specifications
- Coauthored a working paper detailing the theoretical framework, empirical strategy, robustness analyses, findings, and discussion of results

Prof. Benjamin Friedrich, *Northwestern University*, Evanston, IL — May 2022 — Jul 2023

- Built a firm-level dataset by recording and classifying social media activity and linking it with firm characteristics and hiring patterns
- Conducted descriptive and predictive analyses to identify firm characteristics associated with public-facing support for women's career advancement

Works in Progress

Testing for Discrimination in Law Firms: An Outcome Test Approach Last updated: Nov 2026
With Prof. Stephane Mechoulan, Dalhousie University
Abstract: We investigate whether discrimination could account for the well-documented underrepresentation of some groups among law firm partners. Leveraging the *After the JD* dataset and an observational variant of the outcome test, we examine disparities in promotion rates by gender as well as age, parenthood, and law school rank. We find that marginally promoted female partners are less productive than their male peers in terms of billable hours; under the assumptions of the outcome test framework, this is inconsistent with a higher promotion threshold for women. Women nevertheless report substantially more workplace discrimination across the legal profession and at each point in the survey.

Awards

Robert Eisner Award for Undergraduate Research 2024
- Awarded to the graduating senior demonstrating superb talent in public policy research in economics

Magna cum laude 2024
- Granted to students with final grade point averages in the top 13% of their graduating class

Phi Beta Kappa honor society 2024
- Elected to the nation's oldest academic honor society for excellence in the liberal arts and sciences

Second Place, Social Sciences — Undergraduate Research Exposition 2024
- Presented a poster based on my honors thesis and was awarded second place in the Social Sciences division

Dean's List 2020 — 2024
- Each quarter, granted to students with grade point averages of 3.70 or higher

National Merit Scholar 2019
- Selected among ∼7,500 scholarship recipients demonstrating academic potential from 1.6 million entrants

Leadership and Service

Students Organizing for Labor Rights, *Fundraising Team*, Evanston, IL Sep 2022 — Jun 2024
- Wrote a program to automate 100+ personalized monthly donor emails, replacing a manual process
- Collaborated with peers to fundraise for, organize, and run quarterly mutual-aid efforts distributing cash and household supplies to campus workers

North by Northwestern, *Senior Features Editor*, Evanston, IL Sep 2020 — Jun 2024
- Edited articles and collaborated with a 20-student editorial board to publish a 64-page quarterly magazine

Northwestern Womxn in Economics, *President*, Evanston, IL Mar 2021 — Jun 2023
- Led 7 board members in organizing professional, academic, and social programming serving 400+ economics students
- Oversaw new initiatives including an alumni network and transition to external grant funding
- Mentored students through one-on-one advising and study groups connecting 50+ students per quarter

North Star Forward, *Committee Member*, Redwood City, CA Feb 2020 — May 2022
- Worked alongside ∼25 parents, teachers, students, and administrators to analyze demographic, enrollment, and performance data from local middle schools and identify disparities in academic opportunity
- Delivered recommendations to the Redwood City School District Board of Trustees, resulting in new cross-district transportation and increased staffing of bilingual teachers and administrators

Skills

Python, R, Stata, SQL, Git, LaTeX